

Unions win big, but can district pay up?

Price of labor peace will be \$1.2 billion a year for LAUSD. Next up is funding the cost.

By Howard Blume

Three Los Angeles school district unions won major victories with deals that bring hefty raises and prompted celebratory messages about a new chapter in local education progress. But the price of union peace will be nearly \$1.2 billion in annual contract costs, and questions remain about whether the district can afford it.

Double-digit raises have been promised to union workers by a school system that for months has proclaimed that it is in dire financial straits, trapped in deficit spending and facing potential insolvency in four years. Just two months ago the school board voted to send out 3,200 notices of possible layoff, a process that was expected to cut about 700 jobs.

Over the last three days, however, officials appear to have made decisions about their actual financial position that is closer to the unions' interpretation: The district is sitting on multi-billion-dollar reserves that should be used to pay more to teachers, principals and other essential workers in this high-cost city.

Once the raises go into full effect, the annual cost will be \$650 million per year for members of United Teachers Los Angeles, \$490 million for Local 99 of Service Employees International Union and \$75 million for Associated Administrators of Los Angeles, according to L.A. Unified. In addition, as part of the new agreement, the district agreed to rescind more than 200 layoffs and is being pressed to take back more.

[See Unions, A6]



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

STUDENTS, top, head to class as usual on Tuesday. Above, L.A. Mayor Karen Bass stepped into the marathon contract talks to help avoid a work stoppage.

LAUSD strike is averted with 11th-hour deal

In overnight negotiations, the last of three unions agrees to contract terms.

By Howard Blume, Cierra Morgan, Nicole Macias Garibay and Hailey Branson-Potts

A strike that would have shut down schools for nearly 400,000 students was averted at the eleventh hour early Tuesday after the Los Angeles Unified School District reached a tentative agreement with the union that represents workers including custodians, bus drivers and cafeteria workers.

Schools in the nation's second-largest school district were open as usual on Tuesday, to the relief of many families that had scrambled to make child-care arrangements.

The tentative agreement, which includes a 24% increase over three years, was the final milestone needed to avert a walkout, after the union representing teachers and another representing administrators struck deals on Sunday. It came after a tense night of uncertainty as the two sides faced off at the bargaining table, with the

breakthrough announced at 2 a.m., just hours before the start of the school day.

During a mid-morning news conference, Mayor Karen Bass — who said she stepped into the negotiations to avoid a disruptive work stoppage — praised the unions and the district, adding that she was a “proud LAUSD graduate, parent and grandparent” who was happy that her grandson was in class.

“It’s been a long night and it’s been a long few weeks of negotiations, but our schools are open, our kids are in class, and school workers are on the job caring for and shaping the minds of our future,” she said.

Both United Teachers Los Angeles and Associated Administrators of Los Angeles were prepared to strike in solidarity if Local 99 of Service Employees International Union did not reach an agreement.

All three deals still need to be ratified by union members and by the LAUSD Board of Education.

The school district announced the tentative agreement with Local 99 in an alert just five hours before employees were scheduled to picket outside their campuses.

Half an hour later, at 2:30 a.m., Local 99 said on social [See LAUSD, A7]

Fears of a deeper rot in Congress

WASHINGTON — Eric Swalwell’s downfall has raised the possibility of a broader reckoning on Capitol Hill as congressional staffers, reporters and opposition researchers race to verify long-standing rumors of a sordid underground culture among the city’s most powerful.

Former lawmakers across the political spectrum have warned for years of a hushed congressional bacchanal marked by inappropriate revelry and sexual misconduct. But a sense of growing momentum gripped Congress on Tuesday, as Democrats grappled with Swalwell’s resignation and Republicans called for other lawmakers to face scrutiny.

The 72-hour collapse of Swalwell’s political career has shifted attention

Sordid culture is open secret, and young female aides are reportedly warned about some lawmakers

By Michael Wilner, Justine McDaniel and Ana Ceballos

not only to his closest associates in Congress, but also to a larger set of sitting lawmakers from both parties suspected of lurid sexual activity. Several members have claimed that Swalwell’s alleged behavior was an open secret amid a cacophony of rumors on social media of other potential offenders.

“I think that many people knew about this for a while,” Rep. Anna Paulina Luna, a Florida Republican, said in an interview with The Times.

Luna, who planned to lead the charge to expel Swalwell before he resigned, alleged that young staffers would talk among one another about Swalwell’s conduct. Lawmakers should have done more to approach him about [See Congress, A7]

ANOTHER WOMAN ACCUSES SWALWELL OF ASSAULT

She says congressman drugged, raped and choked her in 2018: ‘I thought I died.’

By Rebecca Ellis and Melody Gutierrez

Another woman came forward Tuesday to describe rape allegations against Rep. Eric Swalwell, who announced his resignation from Congress on Monday amid a torrent of sexual misconduct accusations.

Lonna Drewes said at a news conference called by her attorneys that she was drugged and raped by Swalwell (D-Dublin) in 2018 while she was working as a model in Beverly Hills.

Drewes said she met Swalwell three times as she was growing her fashion software company and toying with the idea of a political career.

On the third occasion, she said, she believed he drugged her glass of wine. She said they were supposed to go to a political event and they stopped by his hotel room to retrieve some paperwork.

She said she found herself incapacitated despite having had only one drink.

“He raped me and he choked me and while he was choking me I lost consciousness and I thought I died,” she said. “I did not consent to any sexual activity.”

Swalwell’s attorney Elias Dabaie did not immediately respond to a call or email requesting comment. Swalwell has previously denied allegations against him, while acknowledging undefined “mistakes.”

Swalwell and his team threatened legal action against several individuals over the claims, Dabaie previously confirmed to The Times.

Drewes said she didn’t undergo a rape kit test but disclosed the assault to people close to her and described it in her calendar. She did not have contact [See Accuser, A7]



MARC MARTIN Los Angeles Times

HIKERS are passed by e-bikers at Aliso and Wood Canyons Wilderness Park in Laguna Niguel.

E-bikes bring conflict on state hiking trails

As officials struggle to rewrite safety rules, the motorized cycles spark a backlash.

By Jack Dolan

In bright sunshine, with the Pacific Ocean sparkling far below, two middle-aged men hopped on mountain bikes and started climbing a steep dirt road above Zuma Beach in Malibu. They pedaled up more than 2,000 vertical feet, chatting comfortably about marriage, careers and early retirement.

They did not discuss the fact that, until recently, a climb like this would have reduced them both to gasping wrecks. Or that their brisk pace would only have been possible for world-class athletes.

Their secret? Tiny electric motors tucked between the pedals that quietly quadrupled their leg power.

Across California, electric bikes are proliferating at an astonishing rate as overwhelmed public officials struggle to rewrite the rules of the road.

Nowhere is the tension more obvious than in once-tranquil parks and on remote mountain trails, where people go to escape the maddening march of technology.

The intrusion of e-bikes, with their faint but unmistakable electric whine, is sparking a fierce backlash from traditional trail users and forcing land managers into a confusing new debate over safety and fairness.

To many longtime riders, the whole thing feels like sacrilege.

Traditional mountain [See E-bikes, A11]

Sudan’s civil war has turned its capital into a city of graves

By Nabih Bulos

KHARTOUM, Sudan — The diggers were efficient, cramming in so many graves that, from above, the field near the University of Sudan’s medical campus looked like a frieze of an undulating, gravel-brown sea.

“There’s another one over there that’s even more crowded than this,” a campus caretaker said, pointing to an adjacent lot a few hundred yards away. He trudged back to his post by the campus gate before delivering a laconic response to a reporter’s question.

“How many corpses here?” he repeated. “Hundreds? Thousands? Who knows.”

More than a year after Sudan’s army overwhelmed a rival paramilitary faction and seized Khartoum, the gaping holes in the walls and the shredded pavement bear witness to the fierce battles that turned the Nile-front boulevards of this capital into a charnel house.

In some neighborhoods, it appears no surface was left unscarred by ordnance and shrapnel. The commercial district stands gutted, looted and torched. Even the ancient statues in the capi-

tal’s National Museum — those that weren’t stolen — weren’t spared.

Its international airport — which only recently reopened — has the remains of propeller planes carelessly tossed to the side of the runway, their bodies riddled with bullet holes and their wings askew. Taking off, you see the carcass of an exploded jet, its fuselage filleted open like a fish.

But above all, Khartoum is a city of graves.

It took almost two years of vicious, take-no-prisoners combat for the army to finally push out the militia [See Graves, A4]

Former UCLA doctor sentenced

James Heaps pleads guilty to abusing five patients after an earlier conviction was overturned. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Building giant pulls up stakes

KB Home, which helped create Los Angeles’ sprawling suburbs, is relocating to Arizona. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 76/55 **B6**



MORTEZA NIKOUBAZL NurPhoto

IRAN TALKS MAY RESUME

A flag waves next to a destroyed building in Tehran. President Trump said Pakistan may host a new round of negotiations. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**